ZikShare

ACADEMIC VAULT

UNIZIK FRESHER EDITION | 2026

THA 152: Introduction to Media Arts - Radio, Television and Film Basics

How a media production is actually put together

THEATRE & FILM

Theatre & Film Studies

Faculty of Arts
Theatre & Film Studies | 100L

OUTLINE ARCHIVE: 2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Written for students, by students.

Practical notes, worked examples, practice questions and a revision plan.

Free to download. No fee, no payment step, no watermark.

Independent study support | Not an official UNIZIK publication

START HERE

Why this pack exists

This pack explains the production chain for radio, television and film, the roles in a production team, and the basic grammar of shot sizes and sound. It is the foundation for THA 215, THA 252 and THA 324, so treat it as a map rather than a list of definitions.

This is a student-written study companion, not a reproduced lecture handout or a leaked examination paper. Use it to organise the topics you are taught, practise the kind of thinking your course rewards, and walk into class with better questions.

What you will be able to do

- Describe pre-production, production and post-production stages.
- Identify the roles in a media production team and what each owns.
- Use shot sizes, camera angles and transitions accurately.
- Explain how radio differs from television and film in production logic.

How to use this pack

1. Skim the whole pack once in 20 minutes so you know what is inside.
2. Work through one section at a time with your lecture note and recommended text beside you.
3. Attempt the practice questions before reading the answers. Mark what you missed.
4. Use the final checklist to plan your revision week, one tick per study session.

> **Free to download, always**
> This pack is free. There is no fee, no subscription and no payment step before download, and the full PDF is not watermarked or locked. Share the link with a coursemate instead of forwarding the file.

> **Confirm your official course outline**
> Course codes, credit units and outlines can differ by department and session. Treat this pack as supplementary support and confirm the current outline with your lecturer, course rep or departmental handbook before an assessment.

The production chain

Every production, from a radio jingle to a feature film, moves through three phases.

- Pre-production: idea, script, budget, schedule, crew, location and permissions.
- Production: shooting or recording, with continuity and safety management.
- Post-production: editing, sound, colour, graphics and delivery.
- Radio compresses the chain: script, record, edit, broadcast.
- Failures in pre-production surface as chaos on set.
- Keep a paper trail: scripts, schedules, release forms and logs.

Roles and responsibilities

Credit correctly and know who decides what.

- Producer: money, logistics and overall delivery.
- Director: interpretation and creative decisions.
- Scriptwriter: structure and dialogue.
- Cinematographer or camera operator: image and lighting.
- Sound recordist and designer: dialogue, effects and mix.
- Editor: rhythm, continuity and final structure.

> **Say what you own**
> In group projects, write down who owns which deliverable. Ambiguity is the main cause of 'I did everything' disputes.

Visual grammar and sound

Learn the vocabulary before you analyse a film.

- Shot sizes: extreme wide, wide, medium, close-up, extreme close-up.
- Angles: eye level, high, low, Dutch tilt.
- Movement: pan, tilt, dolly, handheld, crane.
- Transitions: cut, dissolve, fade, wipe.
- Sound: diegetic (inside the story world) and non-diegetic (score, narration).
- Continuity: eyeline, screen direction and the 180-degree rule.

OUTLINE ARCHIVE

Session record: THA 152

2018 - 2019 - 2025/2026

Year demarcation matters: a course code that existed in 2018 may have been renumbered, merged or dropped by 2019, and the department now also runs a film track. Read the year label before you rely on a code. The current entry below is a compiled map - take it to your course rep or the departmental office and confirm it before registration.

2018 — Archived course description — ARCHIVED

- THA 152 Introduction to Media Arts sits inside the 100-level media area
- The 2018 description frames media study through production participation and studio practice
- THA 252 Fundamentals of Radio, Television and Film Production is described on the same page

Source: unizik.edu.ng - Theatre & Film Studies course description (page dated 31 May 2018; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2019 — Archived programme listing — ARCHIVED

- THA 152 Introduction to Media Arts, 3 credits, second semester
- Media stress area continues with THA 215, 252, 324 and 333
- The department describes radio, TV and film as broadcast arts within theatre studies

What changed: The 2019 listing shows a clearer media ladder: 152 introduces, 215 analyses film, 252 introduces production, 324 directs.

Source: arts.unizik.edu.ng - Theatre Arts programme and course map (page dated 18 Oct 2019; original URL now returns 404) (retrieved 2026-10-22)

2025/2026 — Compiled working map — CURRENT WORKING MAP

- Media arts remains the 100-level gateway to the film and broadcast track
- The department now includes Film Studies in its name, so expect stronger film emphasis
- Confirm which editing software and equipment your cohort can access

Source: Compiled by ZikShare from the archived 2018 and 2019 departmental pages plus the published stress areas; this is a working map, not an official handout (retrieved 2026-10-22)

Archive means: this records what a public departmental page listed in that year. It is not a guarantee of the current curriculum, and ZikShare is not affiliated with UNIZIK.

PRACTICE, NOT PREDICTION

Check your understanding

These questions are written for this pack to test the ideas above. They are not past examination questions and do not predict what your lecturer will set. Answer first, then compare.

1. What are the three production phases?

Answer: Pre-production, production and post-production.

2. What is the difference between diegetic and non-diegetic sound?

Answer: Diegetic sound exists in the story world and can be heard by characters; non-diegetic sound, such as a score, is added for the audience.

3. Who is responsible for continuity on set?

Answer: The continuity supervisor or script supervisor, working with the director and editor.

4. Give one reason radio production differs from film production.

Answer: Radio has no visual channel, so it must build place, character and action through voice, sound effects and silence.

5. What is the 180-degree rule?

Answer: Keeping the camera on one side of an imaginary line between two characters preserves consistent screen direction.

Your 7-step action plan

Tick each step only when you have done it. A tick you cannot defend is worse than an empty box.

- [ ] Write the three production phases with tasks for each.
- [ ] Draw a production team chart with ten roles.
- [ ] Learn ten shot types with a sketch of each.
- [ ] Analyse a three-minute scene for shot sizes and sound.
- [ ] Make a one-page radio production plan.
- [ ] Watch a behind-the-scenes documentary and list three logistics lessons.
- [ ] Define diegetic and non-diegetic sound using a scene you know.

Keep going

One pack will not carry a semester. Pair this with your lecture notes, tutorials, and the past questions your department actually releases. If a topic still feels unclear, take a specific question to your lecturer or course rep - "I do not understand the difference between X and Y" gets a better answer than "I do not understand this course".

> **More from the ZikShare Academic Vault**
> Find faculty primers, study-skills guides, money and career packs, and digital-skills workbooks in the ZikShare Library. New packs are added every semester.

ZikShare Academic Vault | Theatre & Film Studies | 100L | 2026 Fresher Edition

YOUR WORKSPACE

Notes, questions and things to ask

Use this page in class or during revision. Write questions you could not answer instead of copying slides.

Three ideas I can now explain without notes:

A question I still cannot answer:

For my lecturer or course rep:

Next revision action and date:

THA 152: Introduction to Media Arts - Radio, Television and Film Basics